

Libcloud now a top-level ASF project

Libcloud, which arrived in the Apache Incubator (where projects mature) in November 2009, has now become a top-level project of the Apache Software Foundation (ASF). Libcloud is a Python implementation of a common vendor-independent API for cloud services. It supports multiple backends to work with cloud provider-specific APIs. In order to move out of the Apache Incubator, a project needs to show that it has developed a well-governed community under the Foundation's principles and processes. The project hopes to allow developers to write cloud applications for a single API without the need to write vendor-specific code.



Google upgrades WebP image format

Google has launched an improved version of the WebP image format, which is designed to reduce the image size on the Web and speed up browsing. WebP is now natively supported in Chrome and Opera. Google products including Gmail and Picasa Web Albums, have also added support to WebP so you can share, send and receive WebP images. WebP support is also coming to AppEngine. In addition, Google Instant Previews now store images in WebP to reduce its storage needs. Google says it is working on transparency (alpha channel) support and will add it to the "...next stable version of the codec."



The WebP format was introduced by the company last year in 2010. "WebP's compression algorithms have been significantly improved while remaining completely compatible with the previous releases," Richard Rabbat, product manager and Pascal Massimino, a programmer at Google stated in a blog post. "On the decoding side, we have integrated a fancy upsampler. Fancy upsampling reduces the pixelation of strong edges. You can see this feature when you zoom in," the blog post added.

The improved version will also include technology that will allow the image-data to be internally decoded during its download. With this feature, users won't have to wait for the entire file to download before being able to watch it.

The Xi3 ChromiumPC is due in July

The Xi3 Corporation has announced that its Chromium OS-based desktop computer will be the first desktop to run the operating system when it launches in early July. The ChromiumPC will be powered by a dual or single core 64-bit CPU and housed in an aluminum chassis. It will be released in several colour choices.



It consists of processor and I/O modules rather than a traditional motherboard. Further, the I/O modules—one for communication ports and the second for other connectivity—are swappable. In the company's announcement, Jason A Sullivan, president and CEO, Xi3 said, "Although we've been promoting, discussing and working on modular computers for some time, we feel the market is now ready for a desktop computer with a cloud-based operating system like

LinuxCon NA 2011

The Linux Foundation has announced its programme and schedule for this year's LinuxCon North America event taking place in Vancouver, B.C. from August 17 to 19, 2011. LinuxCon is said to be the world's leading conference addressing all matters Linux for the global business and technical communities. LinuxCon North America 2011 will host the formal celebration of the 20th Anniversary of Linux, in which Linux creator Linus Torvalds will take part. Torvalds is confirmed to attend LinuxCon and will participate in an interview-style keynote in which he will discuss technical advancements and challenges related to the Linux kernel with kernel developer and maintainer Greg Kroah-Hartman.

The Linux Foundation will also host a '20 Years of Linux' panel that will include Linux and open source luminaries Jon 'Maddog' Hall, the celebrated FOSS veteran and advocate, and Eben Moglen, the founder of the Software Freedom Law Center. The Linux Foundation's executive director, Jim Zemlin, will moderate the exclusive panel.

Also confirmed for the final programme is a keynote from Dr Irving Wladawsky-Berger, chairman emeritus of the IBM Academy of Technology and visiting professor of engineering systems at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). While at IBM, Dr Wladawsky-Berger was responsible for identifying emerging technologies and marketplace developments critical to the future of the IT industry. He will draw upon more than 40 years of experience to provide a unique perspective on Linux and the evolution of IT on the 20th anniversary of Linux.